

Use-case flow - UC-03 Book Counseling Session

Problem Statement #14 - Healthcare & Telemedicine - Corporate Mental Wellness & Counseling Platform

Primary actor: Corporate Employee

Secondary actors: Licensed Therapist (indirect), Notification Service

Goal: Reserve a confidential counselling slot with a licensed therapist without revealing the employee's corporate identity.

Trigger: The employee chooses 'Book a session' from the portal.

Preconditions

1. The employee has an active account and a pseudo-ID has been issued (UC-01).
2. The employee is signed in, and the session carries only the pseudo-ID.
3. At least one licensed therapist has published availability (UC-05).

Postconditions (success)

1. A booking record links the pseudo-ID, the therapist and the chosen slot.
2. The slot is marked unavailable and cannot be booked by anyone else.
3. Both parties hold a confirmation showing the time in their own timezone (NFR-001).
4. The therapist's view of the booking shows the pseudo-ID only (FR-001).

Postcondition (failure): No slot is reserved, the therapist's availability is unchanged, and the employee is told why the booking did not complete.

Main success scenario

1. The employee selects 'Book a session'.
2. The system resolves the signed-in account to its pseudo-ID («include» UC-08).
3. The employee chooses a counselling area and a preferred date range.
4. The system retrieves matching published slots and displays them converted to the employee's local timezone.
5. The employee selects a slot and a session mode (video or chat).
6. The system re-checks that the slot is still free («include» UC-10).
7. The system reserves the slot and writes the booking against the pseudo-ID inside a single transaction.
8. The system generates the session join link and stores it against the booking.
9. The system sends confirmations to the employee and the therapist («include» UC-11), each in the recipient's own timezone.
10. The system shows the employee a confirmation screen with the pseudo-ID, the slot and the join link.
11. The use case ends successfully.

Alternate flows

4a. No therapist has availability in the requested range

- 4a1. The system reports that no slots match and shows the earliest date that does have availability.
- 4a2. The employee either widens the date range and returns to step 3, or leaves the booking; the use case ends without a booking.

6a. The slot was taken while the employee was choosing

- 6a1. The availability check finds the slot already reserved.
- 6a2. The system tells the employee the slot is no longer available and does not reserve anything.
- 6a3. The system refreshes the slot list and returns the employee to step 5.
- 6a4. If the employee's next two attempts also clash, the system offers to place them on the therapist's waitlist and the use case ends without a booking.

9a. The notification service is unreachable

- 9a1. The booking is already committed, so the system keeps it and queues the confirmation for retry.
- 9a2. The confirmation screen at step 10 warns that the email is delayed and shows the join link on screen.
- 9a3. The system retries delivery for up to one hour, then raises an alert for support.

Notes

- Nothing written by this use case carries a corporate identifier. Every record is keyed on the pseudo-ID (FR-001).
- Steps 4 and 9 are where timezone conversion matters, so they are the steps NFR-001 is measured on.
- Once a booking exists, UC-12 extends this use case to reschedule or cancel it.